different approach from that taken in many Deobandi madaris, where the focus is mainly on religious learning. It makes Ahl-e-Hadith madaris an attractive option for lower middle class parents who cannot afford private schools, but want their children to receive the practical tools necessary for future economic success. The fact that students at these madaris generally achieve high exam results boosts their appeal.[88] It is important to note as well that madaris of all sectarian persuasions in Pakistan typically teach students to discount other sects. Thus, promoting one sect implies rejecting others.[89]

Despite these advances, Ahl-e-Hadith Muslims remain a small minority in Pakistan and the movement is also fragmented. Disagreements exist over ritual and strategy, participation in politics and the proper approach to jihad.[90] Similar differences among purists, politicos and jihadis are found in the wider Salafi movement as well.[91] The Markaz-e-Jamiat Ahl-e-Hadith [MJAH] is the main Ahl-e-Hadith organization. It participates in politics and is a member of the Muttahida Majlis-e-Amal [United Action Council or MMA], a coalition of religious parties.[92] The MJAH has several subsidiary organizations that have engaged in violence. One is the Ahl-e-Hadith Youth Force. It has been involved in sectarian disputes against Shia and Barelvi Muslims, including taking over Barelvi mosques to preach the Ahl-e-Hadith creed. Another is the Tehrike-Mujahideen [Movement of Holy Warriors], which emerged in 1989 in Indian-administered Kashmir to wage jihad.[93] It has also taken over a number of Barelvi mosques in Indian-Kashmir and converted them into Ahl-e-Hadith mosques. The Tehrik-e-Mujahideen was not connected to the MJAH until 2000, when the latter absorbed it in response to criticisms that it was only involved in politics and was not waging jihad.[94]

Lashkar avers participation in politics and considers the MJAH to be no longer a Salafi organization because it associates with non-Salafis.[95] The group is also at odds with the mainstream Ahl-e-Hadith movement in general, and the MJAH in particular, over the issue of jihad. Although it is not the only Ahl-e-Hadith organization to wage military jihad, Lashkar is the only one to consider doing so to be an individual and compulsory obligation for all Muslims at the present time. The other Ahl-e-Hadith organizations that participate in jihad consider it to be a collective responsibility, meaning it is not obligatory for all Muslims. Because they do